

Segment 23 Silver Lake Rd to Mulligans Plains West

(Formerly Segment 21), Updated April 2026 [Google Map of Segment 23](#) The Google Map is only for an overview of the trail. **Use Avenza Maps for actually locating and following the trail.**

Trail Adopter(s): Karen Pruess karen.pruess@gmail.com 906 250-4488 Dan & Jessica Thompson dthompson451@gmail.com

Segment length: About 3.25 miles

Link to [Avenza Maps Online](#) Use Maps # 37 & 38 in the Avenza app. Make sure you have the current updates for Avenza. Always refer to the updated Avenza Maps for the most current NCT mile markers. ***Note – this segment was rerouted in 2022.***

Please contact mac@northcountrytrail.org or the Trail Adopter above with reports of trail conditions, including blowdowns, washouts or inadequate blazing,, or if you have questions on driving directions to the start point.

Many of the backroads have multiple names depending on which map you are using. When known, multiple names for the same road have been indicated in italics within brackets.

On the trail: (all trail descriptions will be northbound, follow in reverse for southbound)

The reroute for this segment of trail, brand new in 2022, features only minor elevation changes and meanders through typical hardwood forest (mostly maple) logged in the last decade. The trail also crosses several logging two tracks and a small seasonal step over brook.

From your vehicle on Silver Lake Rd at (46.639558, -87.791880), you will head out on a .3 mile long trail which was logged after a rogue winter storm in October 2022 created a maelstrom of trees. Kudos to Lyme Timber for removing an extreme fire hazard and contacting us to see how they could help to retain and blaze the trail for us. From here the trail skirts a lowland swampy area and then enters an almost mature red pine plantation. The forest will continue to change until you come to an old logging road and turn left. This segment ends at (46.671360,-87.816080), just as you turn left and begin to ascend a steep hill.

Driving Directions:

Eastern Trailhead (southern trailhead for this segment)

From the traffic circle in Ishpeming, follow Deer Lake Ave north. At .2 mile curve left, the sign says Marquette County 573. Continue 6 miles and curve left. Continue 2.4 miles and curve left. Continue 1.2 miles and curve left. Depending on which map you use, the road you just traveled may become Deer Lake Rd/CR 573/CR GO/CR CCO/CR CCH/CR AAH/CR AAO, but it is always the main road when there are intersections. After driving 15 miles from the traffic circle in Ishpeming and just after crossing the Dead River, turn left onto Silver Lake Rd for about .8 miles. You will cross Mulligan Creek and the trailhead will be on the right. There is parking a short way down the road to the right. Using the following Google Map is strongly recommended. [Driving map from Ishpeming to western trailhead parking.](#)

Western Trailhead (northern trailhead for this segment)

Follow the directions for the Eastern Trailhead above. From there, continue on [*Silver Lake Rd./CR AAT*] for .1 mile. Turn right on CR AKC (there is no street sign). Continue for .4 mile and take the left fork. Continue for another 1.5 miles and park along the road or along the logging road to the left at (46.662341,-87.808068). You will need to hike .75 miles on the logging road to reach the western trailhead. Using the following Google Map is strongly recommended. [Driving Map from Ishpeming to S23 West/S24 East Parking.](#)

Camping:

This is a mix of private property and commercial forest lands. As anywhere in Michigan where there are commercial forest lands, you are permitted to camp. Just be sure you are not on private property.

Water Access:

See segments 22 & 24 for the closest reliable water sources.

Seasonal Access Information:

From late spring through early winter a higher clearance vehicle is necessary to reach both trailheads. The trailheads are not reachable via vehicle in the wintertime.